

Make It Do Something

Fabiana Alves Ferreira

1. The feature I chose

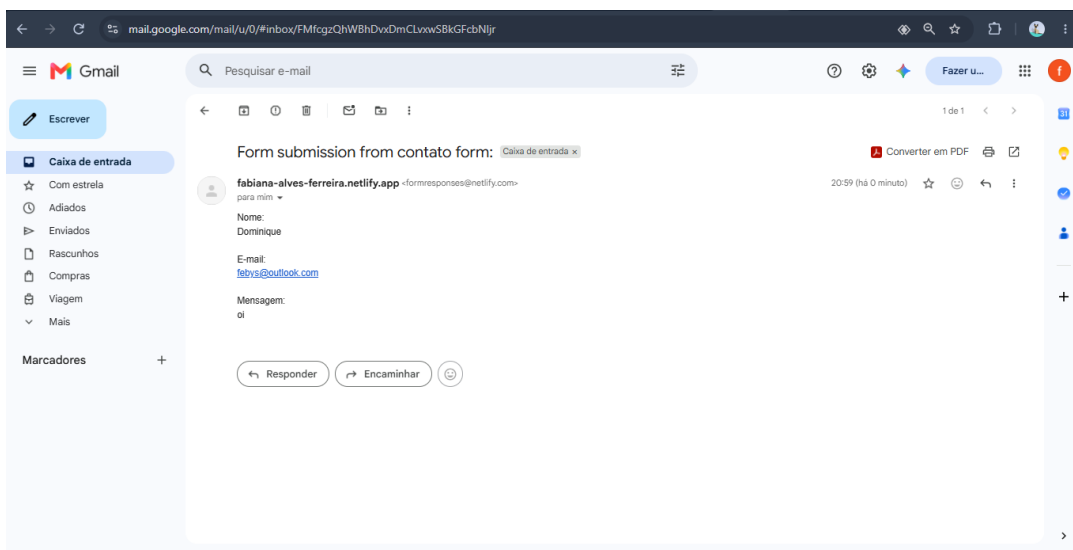
A working contact form on the portfolio's Contact page (in both Portuguese and English), built with Netlify Forms. I chose this feature because it's what the portfolio actually needed: the Contact page already said “schedule a conversation,” but only offered an email link — now there's also a direct way for someone to send a message without leaving the site.

2. How it's connected end to end

The form uses Netlify Forms, free on the same plan already hosting the site — no separate server, account, or external service needed. Adding the **data-netlify="true"** attribute to the HTML is enough for Netlify to detect and process the form automatically on every deploy. I set up an email notification to alert me on every new submission.

3. Proof of a real test

A real person (Dominique) filled out the form on the live site with a real name, email, and message. The notification arrived automatically in my inbox, sent by Netlify's system (formresponses@netlify.com), with all the fields filled in correctly:



Real screenshot of the notification received in Gmail, showing the “contato” form submission.

A note on the process: the first notification attempt used my Outlook email, but the emails never arrived — not in the inbox, not in spam, they simply vanished. I switched the notification email to Gmail, and it worked

immediately, confirming the issue was a silent block on Outlook's side, not a failure in Netlify.

4. Plain-language explanation

There's an intermediary system between my site and my email. On my site, the user types their email and information to get a response. Everything they fill in goes to a kind of automatic digital dropbox (managed by Netlify), where the information is stored securely.

That automated system sends me a notification email letting me know the site had a new submission. I read that message and, from there, contact the person directly using the contact info they left, through my regular email (like Outlook) — my reply doesn't need to go through that dropbox again.

Site: <https://fabiana-alves-ferreira.netlify.app>